

Lehan (Emma) Dong

Mobile: 1-571-4570961 | Email: lehandongwork@gmail.com

GitHub: <https://github.com/LehanDong/lehanproject> | LinkedIn: www.linkedin.com/in/lehandong

EDUCATION & TRAINING

Johns Hopkins University

Jul 2025

M.S., Business Analysis and Risk Management (STEM) | GPA: 3.8/4.0

Awards: Beta Gamma Sigma (Top 20%)

Victoria University & Henan University

Jun 2024

Joint B.S, International Economics and Trade | GPA: 88 / 100 (HD)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Human-Algorithm Interaction Lab

Remote

University of Oxford, Saïd Business School

Feb 2026 – Present

- Processed 3,300 filings (60 firms 5 documents 11 years: earnings calls and 10-K/20-F) to construct a 572 firm-year panel linking CEO sentiment on China to multinational strategic repositioning (2015-2025).
- Applied FinBERT-based sentiment scoring to 15,730 China-related statements; classified firm strategy as exit, maintain, or double-down using NLP-extracted signals from unstructured executive commentary.
- Estimated fixed-effects, ordered logit, binary logit, and IV specifications; conducted reverse-causality, placebo, and first-difference tests to evaluate whether executive rhetoric causally predicts firm strategy shifts.

Research Assistant

Remote

Johns Hopkins University, Carey Business School

Sep 2025 - Present

- Estimated an MDCEV (Multiple Discrete-Continuous Extreme Value) model on 36.2M grocery transactions (2.6 GB panel) to jointly recover within-trip product selection and quantity decisions - satiation, price sensitivity, and cross-product substitution - via L-BFGS-B in Python.
- Building a two-stage demand framework pairing the MDCEV with a Poisson/Negative Binomial visit arrival model (HMM as fallback for latent demand regimes), producing $E[Q_{jt}] = E[N_{jt}] E[q_{jt} | p, a]$ as direct input to pricing optimization and newsvendor inventory problems.
- Framework enables empirical audit of whether observed store-manager pricing heuristics are revenue-optimal - connecting structural demand estimation to operational decision evaluation.

Research Assistant, Center for International Finance and Economics

Remote

Tsinghua University, PBF School of Finance

Jun 2024 – Dec 2025

- Constructed quarterly seigniorage revenue measures from 1951-2026 and estimated Markov regime-switching models to identify structural breaks across monetary regimes; supported 6 research projects under 2 faculty supervisors.
- Analyzed Trump tariff shocks using cross-country panel data across the U.S., U.K., Japan, and EU; examined effects on sectoral employment and firm-level productivity using DiD and panel FE estimators.
- Supported economic analysis of the Hengqin cross-border capital account liberalization project, examining institutional design and capital flow implications.

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

AI Governance Intern

Washington, D.C.

RADAR Governance

Aug - Sep 2025

- Wrote a policy article for RADAR Governance on AI governance in M&A due diligence, examining governance gaps as a source of hidden transaction risk.

Investment Banking Intern

Beijing, China

- Performed valuation and industry analysis for investment banking projects, supporting due diligence, pricing discussions, and client-facing transaction materials.
- Built comparable company, precedent transaction, and discounted cash flow models to assess target valuation and key business drivers.
- Reviewed company filings, financial statements, and sector reports to evaluate business fundamentals, competitive positioning, and growth prospects in pitchbooks and deal materials.

Financial Risk Management Intern

Sichuan, China

KPMG Advisory (China) Limited

Jul 2023 – Sep 2023

- Conducted financial risk and internal control analysis for advisory projects, assessing process design, operational exposure, and compliance risks across key business functions.
- Reviewed control documentation and business records to identify governance gaps, evaluate control effectiveness, and support risk mitigation recommendations.
- Prepared client reports and presentation materials summarizing risk findings, control issues, and proposed improvements in internal control and process management.

SELECTED RESEARCH PROJECTS

ESG Performance and the Cost of Capital of Chinese Listed Firms

- Built a firm-year panel of Chinese A-share listed companies from 2013–2024 to examine how ESG performance affects firms' weighted average cost of capital (WACC).
- Estimated two-way fixed-effects models and conducted robustness checks using alternative WACC measures, lagged specifications, and instrumental-variable approaches to address endogeneity concerns.
- Found that stronger ESG performance is associated with lower capital costs, with the effect driven primarily by reductions in equity financing costs and varying by firm size, industry type, and information environment.

Evaluating Mortgage Lending Equity in the South Atlantic: A CRA-Linked HMDA Analysis

- Analyzed 10M+ rows of HMDA data across 593,033 loan applications using 10 logistic regression specifications to identify approval and pricing disparities for minority and low-income borrowers by CRA-covered lenders.
- Uncovered a paradox: CRA-covered lenders showed higher approval rates but charged elevated interest spreads to minority borrowers - illustrating how regulation and semi-automated underwriting interact to shape credit access.

From Judicial Bias to Algorithmic Injustice: Governing Fairness in AI-Augmented Decision Systems

- Audited 233 domestic violence self-defense rulings across 32 Chinese provinces using OLS, logit, and negative binomial regressions ($p < 0.001$) to quantify sentencing disparities and victim-blaming patterns.
- Developed a governance framework for judicial AI proposing bias-aware optimization, counterfactual data augmentation, and institutional oversight - with direct implications for software testing of fairness properties in high-stakes AI systems.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming:** Python (pandas, NumPy, statsmodels, scikit-learn, PyTorch), R (dplyr, ggplot2), Stata (DID, Panel)
- **ML & NLP:** FinBERT / transformer-based text classification; NLP preprocessing pipelines; MDCEV structural estimation; discrete choice modeling (MSLE, L-BFGS-B)
- **Econometrics:** Panel FE, DiD, IV, Logit/Probit, Negative Binomial, Ordered Logit, Markov-switching, SARIMA/SARIMAX
- **Data & Workflow:** Large-scale data cleaning, reproducible pipelines, Git/GitHub, AWS EC2, ArcGIS, LaTeX

ADDITIONAL

- **Languages:** Native Chinese, Fluent in English, Traditional Chinese
- **License/Certifications:** Microsoft Azure AI Fundamentals (AI-900); MITx Evaluating Social Programs